of my lady friends that I was now unavailable and that they shouldn't contact me any more. I always used to lie awake at night and think, 'Shit, who's going to SMS me now, or phone me?' I never, ever had peace of mind. Even when I was driving in my car with Tenielle, I'd worry about some chick ringing me up.

As I said, I'm not proud to admit to my behaviour, but it proves that I wasn't ready for marriage. Even though I had *really* thought that I was. Now, I don't know if I'm ever going to be ready. Travelling is a big issue for me. How one builds a relationship with another person when you're home for a couple of weeks and then gone for a couple of months at a time is beyond me.

Obviously other guys manage it. Take Shaun Pollock, for example. But Polly is a different kind of guy from me – he doesn't drink, just for starters. At team dinners he might have one or two drinks with the guys, but he never hit the bars and clubs with us. That just isn't Polly. Polly was probably the most together person I've played with. I mean, I played with him for 14 years. Guys like Makhaya Ntini and Ashwell Prince are also cut from the same cloth.

Having said that, some cricketers also appear to be a lot more together than they actually are. There's a lot of stuff that just gets pushed under the carpet; it doesn't come out in the media. I won't mention any names, as that will get me into even more trouble than I already am, but I can tell you that there are some guys in the squad who are not quite as straight up and down as their public image suggests.

I mean … just look at the former Proteas player Jonty Rhodes. His divorce must've come as something of a surprise to the public. And Daryll Cullinan's marriage has also broken up. I didn't even know about his divorce until relatively recently.

And so I ended my marriage. I discussed my feelings with Tenielle before I left for India to play in the inaugural Indian Premier League tournament in 2008. And while I was there I thought long and hard about the whole sad situation. It was there that I finally made up my mind … and I SMSed Tenielle from India saying, 'I think I've put you through enough trouble and heartache and I don't think that this is going to work. I can see it's not going to go anywhere. I don't think I could possibly change and it's best we just go our separate ways.'